

Liebowitz Social Anxiety Scale

Instructions: The first column describes a situation. In the second column, rate how anxious or fearful you feel in the situation. In the third column, rate how often you avoid the situation. If a statement describes a situation you do not ordinarily experience, imagine “what if” you were faced with that situation. Base your ratings on the way each situation has affected you in the last week. Under “Fear,” put the number that indicates your level of fear or anxiety, with 0 = None, 1 = Mild, 2 = Moderate, and 3 = Severe. Under “Avoidance,” put the number that indicates how often you experience each situation, with 0 = Never, 1 = Occasionally, 2 = Often, and 3 = Usually.

Fear / anxiety: 0 = None, 1 = Mild, 2 = Moderate, 3 = Severe

Avoidance: 0 = Never, 1 = Occasionally, 2 = Often, and 3 = Usually

Situation	Fear	Avoidance
Using a telephone in public	2	1
Participating in a small group activity	3	3
Eating in public	2	3
Drinking with others	1	1
Talking to someone in authority	3	3
Acting, performing, or speaking in front of an audience	2	3
Going to a party	3	1
Working while being observed	3	2
Writing while being observed	3	3
Calling someone you don't know very well	3	1
Talking face-to-face with someone you don't know very well	3	1
Meeting strangers	3	1
Urinating in a public bathroom	3	3
Entering a room when others are already seated	2	1
Being the center of attention	2	1
Speaking up at a meeting	3	2
Taking a test of your ability, skill, or knowledge	3	3
Expressing disagreement or disapproval to someone you don't know very well	3	3
Looking someone who you don't know very well straight in the eyes	2	1
Giving a prepared oral talk to a group	3	1
Trying to make someone's acquaintance for the purpose of a romantic/sexual relationship	3	1
Returning goods to a store for a refund	3	1
Giving a party	3	1
Resisting a high-pressure salesperson	3	1
Total score for each column (add up the numbers):	64	42

The Liebowitz Social Anxiety Scale (LSAS) is a questionnaire developed by Dr. Michael R. Liebowitz, a psychiatrist and researcher. This measure assesses the way that social anxiety plays a role in your client's life across a variety of situations.

Number of items: 24

Directions: Give the client the scoring sheet to fill in.

Scoring: Add up the totals for both columns (**Fear** and **Avoidance**): _____

The scoring scale:

0–29	Client does not suffer from social anxiety
30–49	Client experiences mild social anxiety
50–64	Client experiences moderate social anxiety
65–79	Client experiences marked social anxiety
80–94	Client experiences severe social anxiety
> 95	Client experiences very severe social anxiety

Source:

Heimburg, R. G. & Becker, R. E. (2002). Cognitive-Behavioral Group Therapy for Social Phobia. New York, NY: The Guilford Press.